

**VIETNAM NATIONAL UNIVERSITY, HO CHI MINH CITY
HO CHI MINH CITY UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY
FACULTY OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING**



**REPORT
SPECIALIZED PROJECT**

SEMESTER 241 ACADEMIC YEAR 2024-2025

**CODERANK SYSTEM
ONLINE PLATFORM FOR ALGORITHM PRACTICE
AND PROGRAMMING CONTEST
FOR VIETNAMESE IT STUDENT**

MAJOR: COMPUTER SCIENCE

THESIS COMMITTEE : SOFTWARE ENGINEERING - 08 CLC

SUPERVISOR(s) : ASSOC. PROF. QUAN THANH THO

STUDENT 1 : NGUYEN CHAU HOANG LONG (2252444)

STUDENT 2 : CAO NGOC LAM (2252419)

HO CHI MINH CITY, DECEMBER 2025



Thank you

I like to acknowledge ...

Contents

1	Introduction	5
1.1	Problem statement	5
1.2	Goals	6
1.3	Scope	7
2	Technology Stack	8
2.1	Sandboxed Execution Environment	9
2.1.1	Firecracker MicroVMs	9
3	System Design and Analysis	10
3.1	Related works	10
3.1.1	Leetcode	10
3.1.2	Codeforces	11
3.1.3	Websites comparison	12
3.2	Requirement analysis	13
3.2.1	Stakeholders	13
3.2.2	Functional requirements	14
3.2.3	Non-functional requirements	16
3.3	Use Cases	17
3.3.1	General Use Case	17
3.3.2	Use-case diagrams for each submodule	18
3.3.2.1	Use-case description tables	21
3.3.3	Architecture Diagram	22
3.3.3.1	Architectural Decision Rationale	22
3.3.3.2	System Components	23
3.4	Code Runner	25
3.4.1	Overview	25
3.4.2	Class Diagram	25
3.4.3	Testcase Format	26
4	Future Plan and Work Evaluation	28

List of Figures

3.1	Leetcode Homepage	10
3.2	Codeforces Homepage	12
3.3	General Use Case	17
3.4	Authentication & Authorization Use Case	18
3.5	System Management Use Case	19
3.6	Discussion Use Case	20
3.7	Submission Use Case	21
3.8	Architecture Diagram	23
3.9	Layered Architecture	24
3.10	Class Diagram for Code Runner	26



List of Tables

3.1	Comparison of existing website with CodeRank	13
-----	--	----

Chapter 1

Introduction

In Chapter 1, the authors provide a comprehensive introduction to the project's domain, presenting the relevant background and context. Based on this overview, the problem statement is carefully formulated, emphasizing its significance, scope, and the main objectives that the project aims to achieve.

1.1 Problem statement

With the rapid progress in educational technology, the concept of an online coding platform with a ranking system for students is increasingly recognized as a valuable tool to enhance learning outcomes, foster problem-solving skills as well as serving as a solid foundation to prepare students for real-world job interviews in the labor market. While some recognized global platforms such as LeetCode and Codeforces provide extensive resources for competitive programming, there remains a gap in platforms tailored specifically to the needs of Vietnamese students. Current solutions do not fully address the language preferences, localized content, or the collaborative opportunities required to create a holistic learning environment. Consequently, it is essential to enhance the manner in which students approach coding problems, submit their solutions, and collaborate with peers in an effective and intuitive way.

One of the primary challenges lies in problem management and submission tracking. Students require a system that allows them to browse coding problems by category and difficulty, submit solutions with immediate evaluation, and track their performance over time. The lack of a structured and interactive ranking mechanism can reduce motivation and hinder continuous improvement, as students may struggle to assess their progress and compare their performance with peers effectively.

Another significant challenge is fostering real-time collaboration and discussion. Existing

platforms often lack localized forums where students can post questions, discuss problem-solving strategies, and exchange knowledge in their own language. Without an integrated discussion system, students may confront barriers in clarifying ambiguities and engage in collaborative learning, which significantly curtails both overall engagement and the depth of the learning experience.

In summary, the system must be accessible and intuitive, catering to students with various levels of programming expertise. By offering a user-friendly interface, real-time submission feedback, a ranking system, and an integrated discussion forum, the platform can foster an interactive and engaging environment. This approach encourages students to actively participate, receive immediate feedback on their work, and collaborate effectively with their peers, thereby enhancing the overall learning experience. These challenges highlight the necessity of a system designed specifically for Vietnamese students that integrates problem-solving, submission tracking, and collaborative learning in a seamless manner.

1.2 Goals

The main goal of this project is to design and implement a Code Ranking System specifically tailored for Vietnamese students, addressing the challenges identified in the problem statement. The system aims to provide an intuitive and accessible platform that allows undergraduates to effectively engage with coding problems, submit solutions, and interact with their peers. By focusing on usability and real-time feedback, the platform seeks to enhance learning outcomes and foster a collaborative environment.

Firstly, the system will enable students to browse coding problems organized by category and difficulty level, with clear description and examples. Students will be able to submit their solutions and receive immediate evaluation, allowing them to track their progress and monitor improvement over time. A structured ranking mechanism will provide motivation and encourage healthy competition among users.

Secondly, the platform will incorporate real-time centralized discussion features, where students can post questions, share strategies, and collaborate with peers in their native language. This will help clarify ambiguities, promote knowledge sharing, and deepen the learning experience.

Thirdly, the platform will provide a free chatbot feature that allows students to ask questions and engage with the bot regarding topics relevant to coding, problem-solving, and real-world interview scenarios in the Vietnamese job market. This chatbot aims to simulate practical

interview discussions, offer guidance, and help students prepare for professional opportunities.

Finally, the platform will support teachers and moderators with administrative functionalities. These include problem management, monitoring student submissions, and generating performance statistics, thereby providing insights to improve teaching strategies and maintain a structured, high-quality learning environment.

In summary, this project aims to create an interactive, motivating, and collaborative coding platform for Vietnamese students, facilitating skill development, real-time feedback, peer engagement, and practical interview preparation, while bridging the gap between global competitive programming platforms and the local educational context.

1.3 Scope

Our team is developing a web-based platform specifically designed for desktop users, integrating AI-driven features to enhance the learning and coding experience.

- **Website:** By focusing on PC compatibility, the platform ensures smooth navigation and interaction for students. Key modules include problem exploration, solution submission, ranking system, and a centralized discussion forum where students can engage, share insights, and collaborate.
- **AI-powered Assistance:** The system incorporates an intelligent chatbot that helps students with coding guidance and interview preparation. Using natural language processing, the chatbot can interpret questions and provide personalized recommendations, enabling students to improve their skills and gain practical experience in preparing for real-world job opportunities.

Chapter 2

Technology Stack

The purpose of Chapter 2 is to provide a comprehensive technical overview and rationale behind the selection of the platform's diverse technology stack. The authors articulate the specifics of the chosen front-end and back-end frameworks, the database management system, and the integration of the LLM model to facilitate the conversational chatbot feature.

2.1 Sandboxed Execution Environment

In the world of cybersecurity, a **sandbox environment** is an isolated virtual machine in which potentially unsafe software code can execute without affecting network resources or local applications. Think of a sandbox as a controlled playground where applications, code, and files can be tested or executed to see how they behave. If the software behaves maliciously or unexpectedly, it doesn't have the power to affect anything outside of that contained environment. [2]

In the context of CodeRank System, this mechanism is essential because the platform allows users to submit arbitrary source code for compilation and execution as part of algorithm practice and programming contests. Without sandboxing, user submissions could intentionally or accidentally access the file system, overload system resources, execute harmful commands, or interfere with other users' submissions. By running each submission inside a sandbox, CodeRank ensures that all code is contained, resource-restricted, and prevented from performing dangerous operations. This guarantees fair evaluation, protects the platform's infrastructure, and maintains a secure environment for all Vietnamese IT students using the system.

By considering the requirements for securely running user-submitted code, it is essential to evaluate different execution sandbox technologies used in modern online judge systems. In the following section, three representative tools will be introduced and compared in terms of security, performance, isolation level, and ease of integration.

2.1.1 Firecracker MicroVMs

Firecracker is an open source virtualization technology that is purpose-built for creating and managing secure, multi-tenant container and function-based services. Firecracker enables you to deploy workloads in lightweight virtual machines, called microVMs, which provide enhanced security and workload isolation over traditional VMs, while enabling the speed and resource efficiency of containers. Firecracker was developed at Amazon Web Services to improve the customer experience of services like AWS Lambda and AWS Fargate. [1]

Chapter 3

System Design and Analysis

Chapter 3 first provides a comparative analysis of similar applications, evaluating their strengths and limitations. This is followed by a detailed specification of the system requirements and use cases necessary to address the project's core challenges. Finally, the chapter concludes by defining the system's architecture, database schema, AI adaptability, and the finalized wireframe design.

3.1 Related works

3.1.1 Leetcode

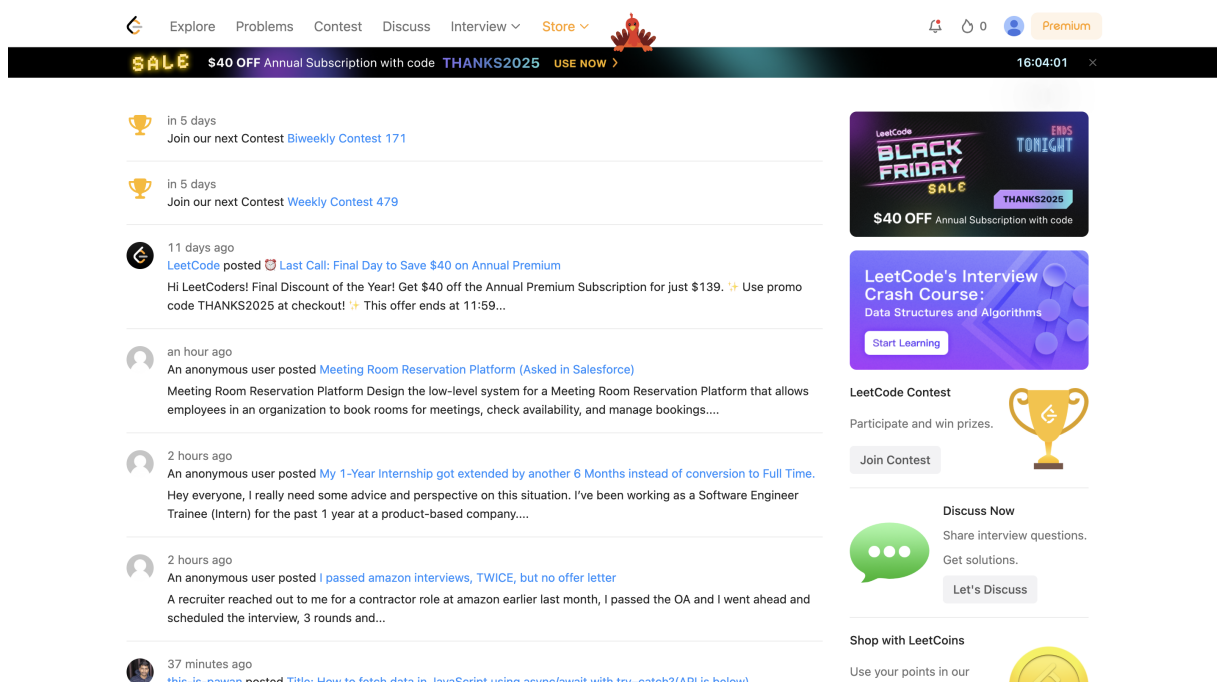


Figure 3.1: Leetcode Homepage

LeetCode, founded in 2015 based on the co-founders' experiences working at Google and Amazon, has become a highly popular online coding platform that offers a large collection of programming problems for all skill levels. It offers a comprehensive environment where users can practice a wide variety of programming problems, engage with a global community, and track their progress over time. LeetCode is widely recognized for its role in fostering problem-solving abilities and strengthening algorithmic thinking, making it an essential tool for both students and professionals in the software engineering field.

Key features of LeetCode include:

- **Extensive Problem Library:** Thousands of coding problems across multiple difficulty levels and topics.
- **Online Code Editor:** Supports multiple programming languages with instant feedback and test case evaluation.
- **Contest and Challenge System:** Regular coding contests to benchmark skills against a global community.
- **Interview Preparation Kits:** Curated problem sets designed to prepare users for technical interviews at top tech companies.
- **Discussion Forums:** Active community discussions for problem-solving strategies, solutions, and learning resources.
- **Progress Tracking and Analytics:** Tools to monitor performance, problem-solving patterns, and skill improvement over time.

LeetCode offers a diverse set of core features that comprehensively address the needs of different user roles, including problem solving, submission tracking, contest participation, community interaction, ranking, and interview preparation. These features collectively enhance the learning experience, promote skill development, and encourage active engagement within the platform. However, it is noteworthy that LeetCode currently does not provide a public leaderboard to foster a stronger competitive environment among users. Additionally, while users can participate in official contests organized by LeetCode, the platform does not support user-generated contests, limiting the flexibility for personalized contest creation.

3.1.2 Codeforces

Codeforces is a prominent online platform dedicated to competitive programming, offering users a structured environment to enhance their algorithmic and problem-solving skills through real-time contests. It is widely used by students, professionals, and competitive programmers to benchmark their abilities and engage with a global community of coders.

Key features of LeetCode include:

- **Extensive Problem Sets:** A vast collection of algorithmic and programming problems

CODEFORCES
Sponsored by TON

longnguyendt04 | Logout

HOME TOP CATALOG CONTESTS GYM PROBLEMSET GROUPS RATING EDU API CALENDAR HELP

OCPC 2026 Winter

By [adamant](#), 5 hours ago,

Hi everyone!

Supported by

The **OCPC** (Osijek Competitive Programming Camp), an [award-winning](#) camp for university students to prepare for ICPC and other coding competitions, is back again this winter, on **January 24 – February 1, 2026!**

The camp is organized by [adamant](#) and [-is-this-ft-](#) on the premises of the University of Osijek in Osijek, Croatia.

The camp is inspired by various competitive programming camps that we attended during our active years in ICPC, and is aimed to help college students prepare for ICPC regional contests and finals. The camp will consist of 7 ICPC-style contests and 2 days off.

Details

The participation fee for both online and onsite participants is **198€ per team**.

Similar to previous camp editions, the fee does *not* include regular meals, travel or accommodation.

We support and empathize with those affected by the ongoing war in Ukraine, therefore we offer a **free participation** for affected individuals and teams affiliated with Ukrainian institutions.

→ **Pay attention**

Before contest
[Codeforces Round \(Div. 2\)](#)
4 days
[Register now »](#)
*has extra registration

→ **longnguyendt04**

★ Contribution: 0

- [Settings](#)
- [Blog](#)
- [Teams](#)
- [Submissions](#)
- [Talks](#)
- [Contests](#)

longnguyendt04

→ **Top rated**

#	User	Rating
1	tourist	3757
2	Benq	3738
3	jiangly	3705
3	Kevin114514	3705
5	orzdevinwang	3670
6	ksun48	3668
7	Radewoosh	3531
8	maroonrk	3443
9	dKqwq	3436

Figure 3.2: Codeforces Homepage

across multiple difficulty levels.

- **Online Contests:** Regular timed competitions, including rated contests, that simulate real-world competitive programming scenarios.
- **Integrated Code Editor:** Supports multiple programming languages with submission, testing, and evaluation against problem test cases.
- **Community Discussion:** Active forums for problem discussions, solution sharing, and peer feedback.
- **User Ratings and Rankings:** Automatic rating system reflecting performance in contests and overall ranking among users globally.
- **Problem Tags and Difficulty Filters:** Tools to browse and search problems efficiently based on difficulty, topic, and tags.

Codeforces excels in providing a practical, competition-oriented environment that strengthens real-world programming and algorithmic skills. Its focus on timed contests and rigorous problem solving makes it an excellent platform for users aiming to improve performance in competitive programming. However, Codeforces does not currently provide dedicated tools for technical interview preparation, such as virtual assistants, hints, or structured interview question sets.

3.1.3 Websites comparison

Obviously, each platform has its own strengths: LeetCode offers an extensive problem library and dedicated interview preparation resources, while Codeforces emphasizes timed

Table 3.1: *Comparison of existing website with CodeRank*

Criteria	LeetCode	Codeforces	CodeRank
Problem Library	Yes	Yes	Yes
Online Coding Editor	Yes	Yes	Yes
Community	Active discussion forums	Active forums with contest discussions	Centralized real-time discussion forums
Contest System	Regular contests organized by platform	Timed contests with system-created schedule	Both official and user-created contests, customizable by users.
Interview Preparation	Yes	No	Yes
Ranking System	Points for solved problems, but not visible to all users	Rating system based on contest performance	Dynamic points for problem solving and public centralized leaderboard
Multilingual	Support English & Chinese	Support English & Russian	Support English & Vietnamese

contests, a rating system, and community-driven forums for competitive practice. However, CodeRank combines these advantages and adds key enhancements, including both official and user-created contests with customizable settings, a centralized public leaderboard, real-time discussion forums, and multilingual support (including Vietnamese). These features make CodeRank a comprehensive, user-centered platform tailored to the educational and practical needs of Vietnamese IT students.

3.2 Requirement analysis

3.2.1 Stakeholders

In any software system, understanding the stakeholders is essential for defining responsibilities, ensuring smooth operation, and aligning the platform with user needs. This project identifies three main groups of stakeholders, each playing a critical role in the development, management, and effective use of the platform. The following sections describe these groups in detail: Primary Users, Moderators, and Superadmin.

1. Primary Users

Primary users consist of students, programming contestants, and job seekers who utilize the platform to enhance their coding abilities and evaluate their technical proficiency. These users engage with the system by practicing programming challenges, submitting solutions for automated evaluation, and participating in online contests that allow them to monitor their progress and compare performance with peers. Additionally, they may take part in

discussion forums to exchange ideas and seek guidance. The platform also provides access to an integrated virtual assistant designed to support interview preparation, enabling users to develop both competitive and career-readiness skills.

2. Moderators

Moderators serve as the quality control and management layer of the platform. Their responsibilities include reviewing problem statements, validating test cases, and monitoring ongoing contests to ensure fairness and a seamless experience for all participants. Moreover, moderators oversee the integrity of the system by detecting plagiarism, resolving disputes, and upholding community standards within discussion forums. Their involvement is essential for maintaining a trustworthy, transparent, and academically honest environment.

3. Superadmin

The Superadmin holds the highest level of authority within the system and is responsible for overarching platform management. In addition to performing all moderator functions, the Superadmin oversees system-wide operations, configures platform policies, and supervises both moderators and regular users. Their core duties include creating and managing moderator accounts, managing roles, addressing escalated issues, and monitoring system performance through analytics and operational metrics. This role ensures that the platform remains stable, secure, and aligned with organizational objectives.

3.2.2 Functional requirements

Primary Users

1. Authentication:

- The system shall allow users to create an account using email and password or third-party authentication providers (e.g., Google, GitHub).
- The system shall support secure login and logout functionality.
- The system shall provide password recovery and reset options.
- The system shall enforce role-based access control to differentiate between standard users, moderators, and superadmins.

2. Problem Solving and Submission:

- The system shall allow users to browse and search algorithmic problems by difficulty, topic, tags, and status (solved, attempted).
- The system shall provide an integrated code editor supporting multiple programming languages (C++, Java, Python), enabling users to write, compile, and execute their code against provided example test cases.
- The system shall display immediate feedback on submitted solutions, indicating success/failure, execution time, memory usage, and specific error messages (e.g., Wrong Answer, Time Limit Exceeded, Runtime Error).

- The system shall allow users to view their past submissions and their results.

3. *Contest Participation:*

- The system shall enable users to create or participate in online programming contests. In case the users want to create an online contest, they can enforce the contest rules, such as time limits per problem and penalty for incorrect submissions.
- The system shall display a leaderboard after the contests finish.

4. *Community forum:*

- The system shall provide a shared discussion forum where users can exchange ideas, ask questions, and discuss solutions for all problems, similar to a general online community forum.
- The system shall allow users to upvote/downvote comments and report inappropriate content.

5. *Ranking System:*

- The system shall assign points to users upon successfully solving problems, with points varying according to the difficulty of each problem.
- The ranking system shall update user scores and global rankings every 15 minutes, reflecting users' latest achievements and progress.

6. *Interview Preparation (Virtual Assistant):*

- The system shall offer a virtual assistant feature for practicing interview questions (e.g., mock interviews with predefined scenarios).
- The system shall provide hints and feedback on interview responses.

Moderators

1. *Problems Management:*

- The system shall allow moderators to create, edit, and publish new algorithmic problems.
- The system shall enable moderators to define problem statements, input/output formats, constraints, and sample test cases.
- The system shall allow moderators to upload and manage hidden test cases for problem evaluation.

2. *Contest Management:*

- The system shall allow moderators to receive and review requests from users for creating new contests. Moderators shall have the ability to either approve or reject these contest creation demands, providing a reason for rejection if applicable. Upon approval, the system shall notify the requesting user and enable the moderator to proceed with configuring and publishing the contest.

3. *Community Moderation:*

- The system shall allow moderators to review and manage content in discussion forums, including deleting inappropriate posts or comments.

- The system shall enable moderators to warn or ban users who violate community guidelines.

Superadmin

The Superadmin shall possess all the functional capabilities and permissions granted to a moderator.

1. *User and Moderator Account Management:*

- The system shall allow the Superadmin to create, edit, suspend, and delete user and moderator accounts.
- The system shall enable moderators to warn or ban users who violate community guidelines.

3.2.3 Non-functional requirements

Performance: The system shall support at least 1,000 concurrent users while maintaining minimal latency during contests. Code submissions must be evaluated and feedback returned within 3 seconds for standard test cases, ensuring a responsive and smooth user experience.

Scalability: The system shall be designed to support horizontal scaling, allowing it to handle increasing numbers of users and higher workloads by adding additional servers or computational resources as needed.

Reliability: The system shall maintain high availability, particularly during contests and peak usage periods. Mechanisms for fault tolerance and recovery shall be implemented to minimize downtime and ensure continuous operation.

Security: The system shall safeguard user accounts, code submissions, and any sensitive data (including payment information) through industry-standard security measures, such as encryption, secure authentication, and role-based access control.

Usability: The system shall provide an intuitive and user-friendly interface suitable for both beginners and advanced users. Users should be able to quickly locate problems by difficulty or topic, join contests with minimal steps, and utilize the integrated code editor without additional setup.

Maintainability: The system shall be designed for ease of maintenance, allowing developers to update features, fix bugs, and enhance functionality with minimal effort and disruption.

Internationalization & Localization: The system shall support multiple languages and provide

seamless switching between them, ensuring accessibility and usability for a diverse, global user base.

3.3 Use Cases

3.3.1 General Use Case

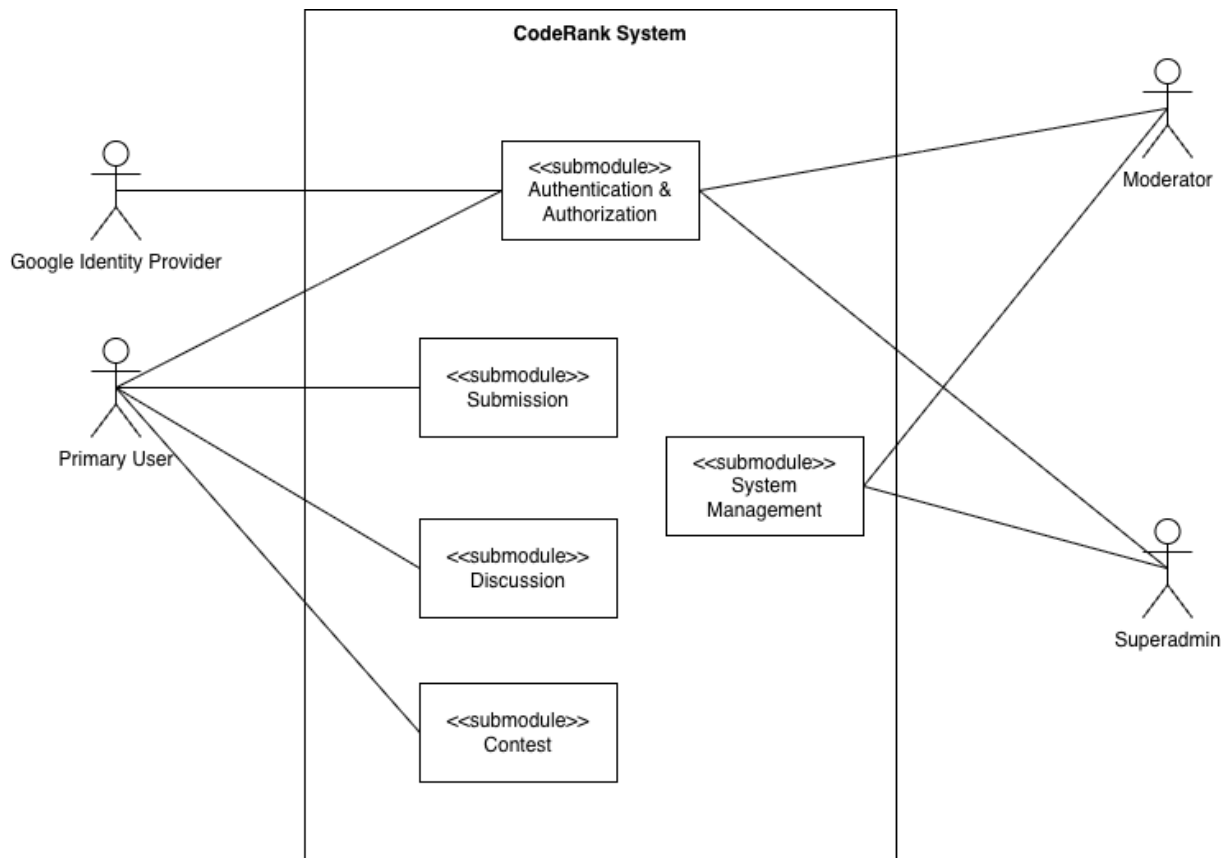


Figure 3.3: General Use Case

Our system contains 5 main submodules:

- **Authentication & Authorization:** Responsible for managing secure login and enforces Role-Based Access Control for 3 types of user.
- **Discussion:** Facilitates community interaction, allowing primary users to share solutions and ask questions related to problems.
- **System Management:** The administrative interface used by Moderator and Superadmin to manage the problem creation, test cases, contests management and global user accounts. Contest: Enables timed, high-stakes programming events with real-time ranking and automated leaderboards.
- **Submission:** This core module handles the presentation of the coding challenge and the automatic evaluation of the user's submitted solution.

3.3.2 Use-case diagrams for each submodule

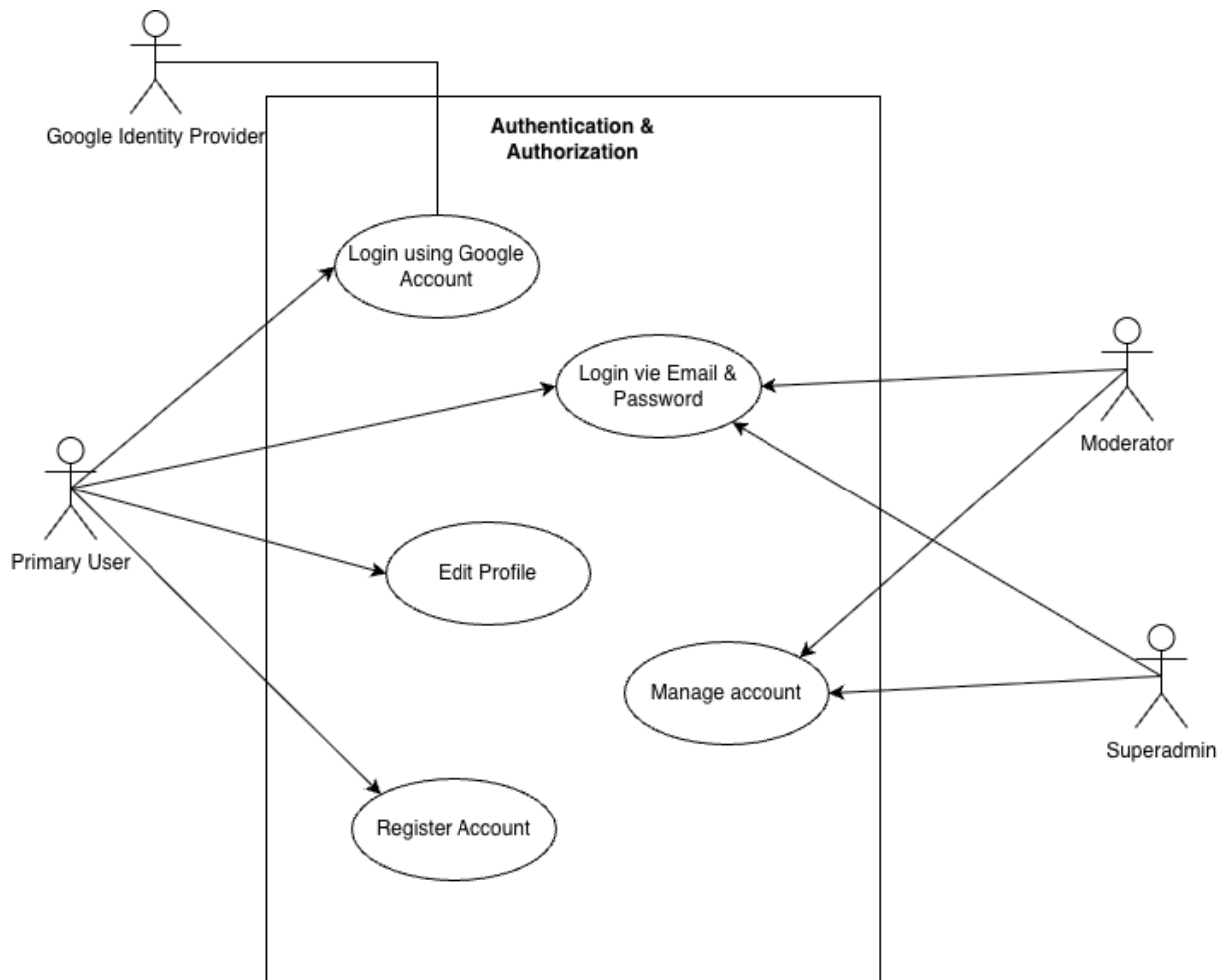


Figure 3.4: *Authentication & Authorization Use Case*

This submodule serves as the primary security gate for the entire system. Its core responsibility is to handle all user authentication (logging in) and authorization (managing access rights). This is crucial for protecting users' personal information, ensuring data privacy, and securing sensitive actions within the platform. By strictly controlling access, the module prevents unauthorized entry and maintains system integrity. For user convenience, we offer diverse login methods:

- Primary Users can log in quickly using their Google Account or use the traditional **Email & Password** method.
- However, for privileged administrative roles—the Moderator and the Superadmin—access is strictly limited to the Login via **Email & Password** method to enforce heightened security and traceability for system management functions.

All users retain standard account management capabilities, including registering a new account and changing their password.

The **System Management submodule** is the administrative dashboard used exclusively by

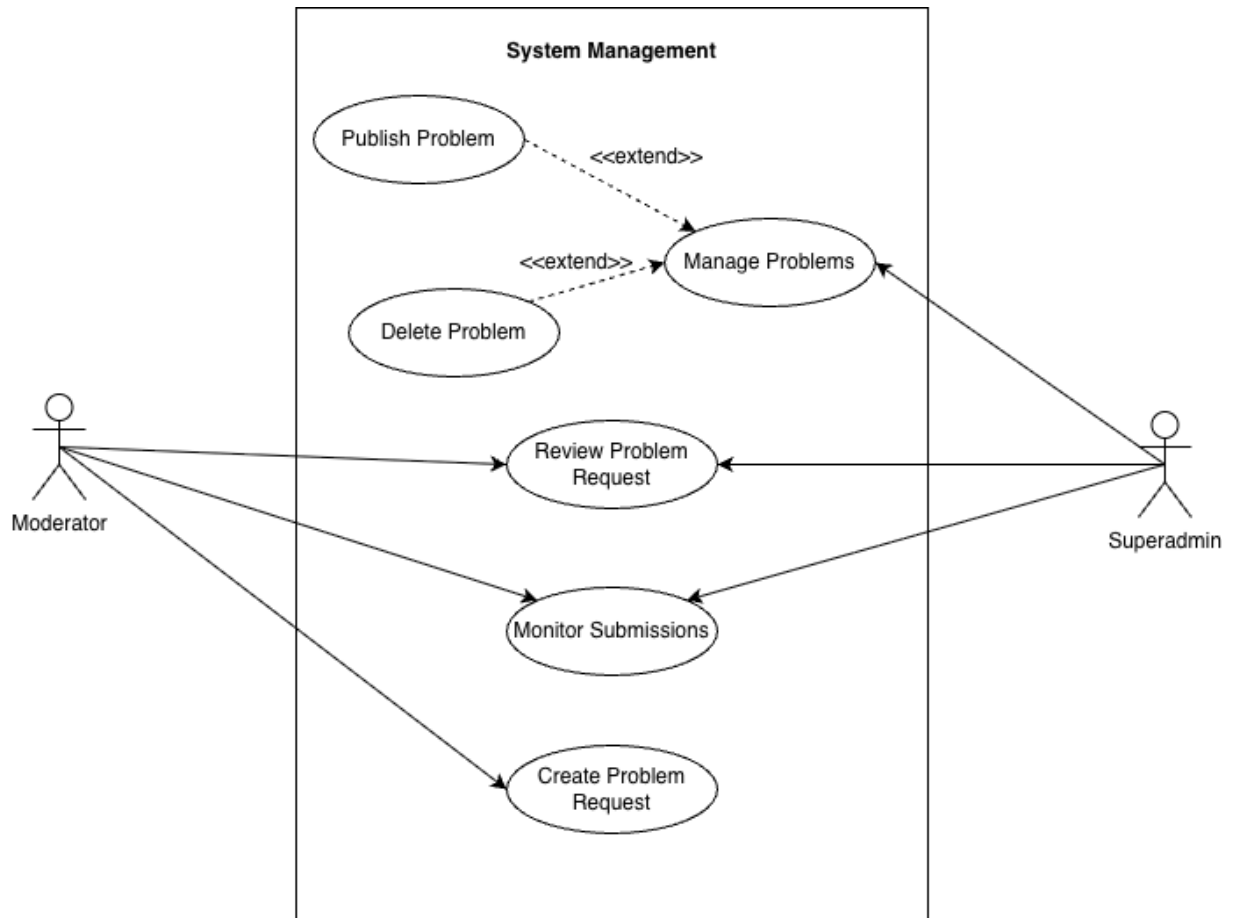


Figure 3.5: *System Management Use Case*

the **Moderator** and **Superadmin** roles to control the content and operation of the platform.

- **Problem Management:** Only Superadmin is enabled to manage problems directly (create, modify, delete) without reviewing steps
- **Content Workflow:** The Moderator initiates a Create Problem Request, and both the Moderator and Superadmin review problem requests before they go live.
- **Quality Control:** Both roles Monitor Submissions to track user activity, diagnose potential grading issues, and ensure fair play.

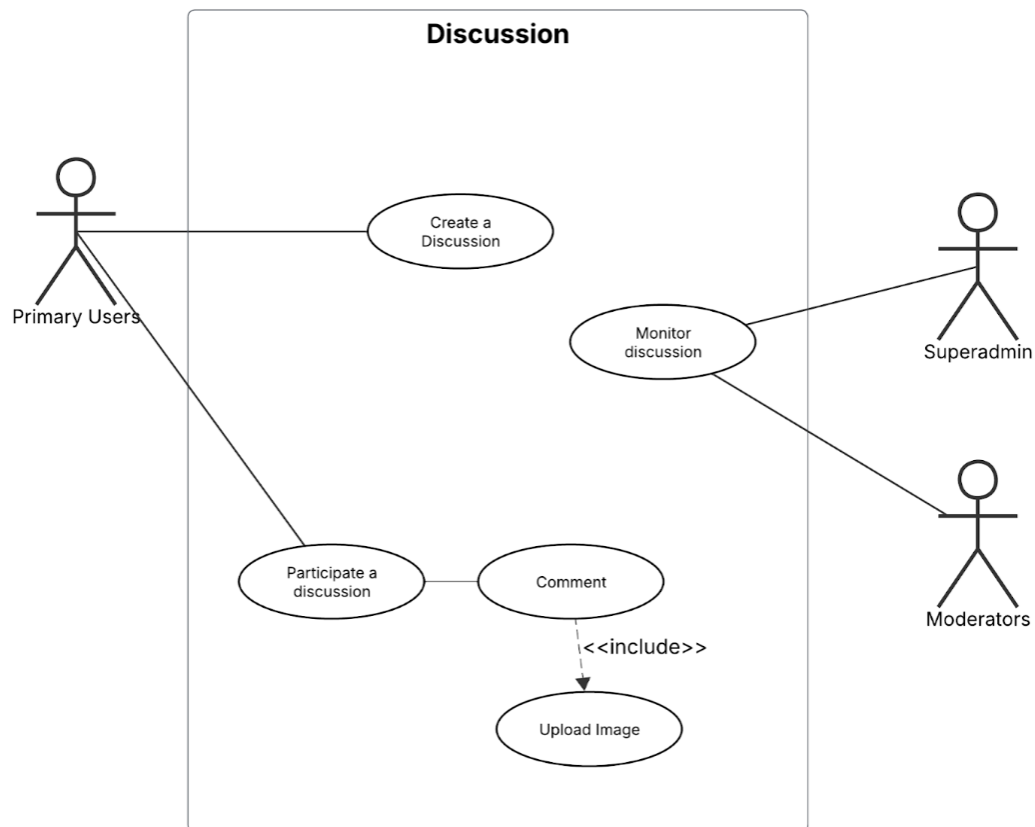


Figure 3.6: *Discussion Use Case*

The **Discussion submodule** helps make CodeRank a friendly and interactive community where users can learn from each other. With the Create Discussion feature, users can start new discussion threads about coding problems, programming ideas, or any tech-related topic. After a thread is created, others can join in by commenting on that thread. Comments can include rich content, such as images added, making explanations clearer and easier to follow. To ensure that discussions remain constructive and aligned with community guidelines, the submodule integrates essential administrative controls. Both the Superadmin and Moderators utilize the Monitor Discussion function to oversee user activity, identify and address inappropriate content, and uphold the platform's community standards.

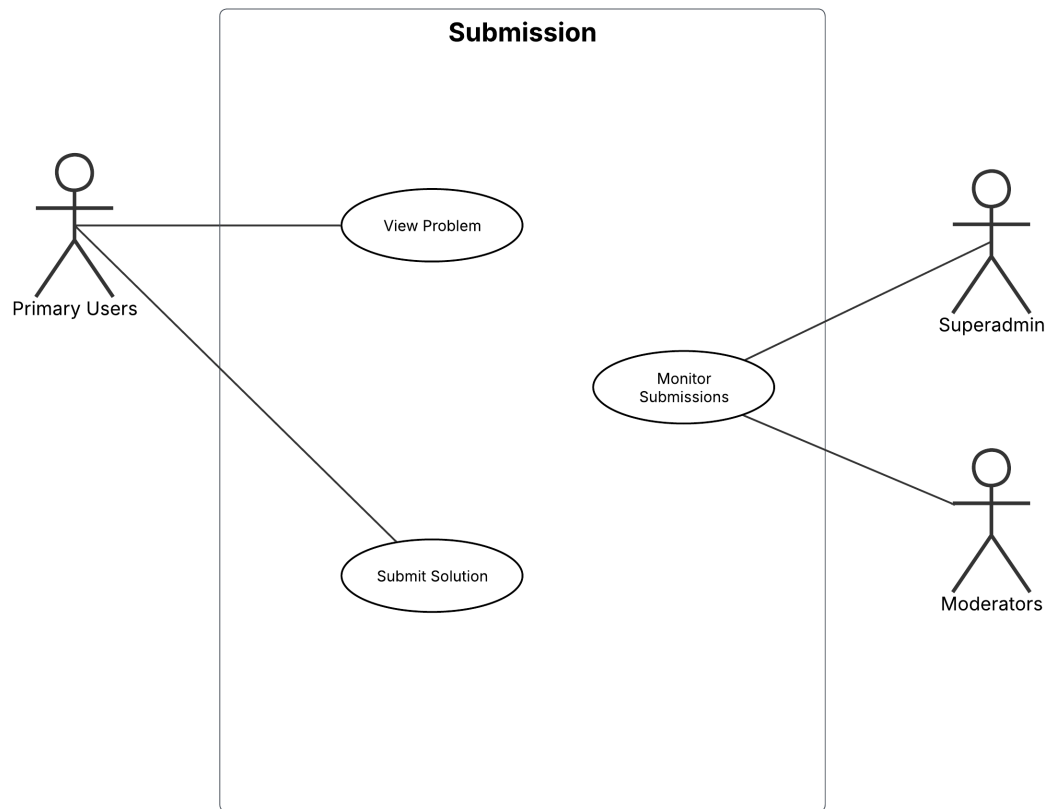


Figure 3.7: *Submission Use Case*

The **Submission** submodule is the core execution engine and interaction point for all coding activities within the CodeRank system. Its primary function is to facilitate the practice and assessment workflow for the Primary User. Users begin by accessing the **View Problem** function, which presents the algorithmic challenge and requirements. The fundamental action in this module is the **Submit Solution** function, which securely receives the user's code, initiates the automatic grading process in a sandboxed environment, and returns the execution verdict. For oversight and quality assurance, both the Superadmin and Moderators are granted the ability to Monitor Submissions. This administrative function is vital for diagnosing issues with test cases, tracking potential cases of plagiarism, and ensuring the overall stability and fairness of the automated grading system.

3.3.2.1 Use-case description tables

3.3.3 Architecture Diagram

3.3.3.1 Architectural Decision Rationale

Architectural diagrams provide a structured view of how a software system is organized and how its components interact. In modern software development, two primary architectural styles are commonly considered: **monolithic architecture** and **distributed (microservice) architecture**.

A **monolithic architecture** consolidates all application logic into a single deployable unit. This style offers simplicity, easier debugging, and lower operational cost, but may become difficult to scale or maintain as the system grows. In contrast, a **distributed architecture** breaks the system into independent services that communicate through network protocols. This design provides modularity, improved fault isolation, and scalability, but also introduces additional complexity in deployment, communication, and monitoring.

The choice between these architectural approaches depends on the project's specific requirements, team size, and long-term goals. Smaller systems or teams often benefit from the straightforwardness of monolithic architecture, while larger, more complex systems may require the flexibility and scalability of distributed services.

After evaluating our project goals and team constraints, we decided to implement a service-based modular monolith as the core architectural foundation for CodeRank. This design offers a balanced middle ground, allowing us to structure our system into clear modules while maintaining the simplicity of a single deployable unit. The key reasons for selecting this approach include:

- **Team Size and Feasibility** With only two participants, adopting a full microservice architecture would introduce significant overhead in DevOps, deployment, and service management. A modular monolith allows us to focus on implementing core features without the burden of distributed complexity.
- **Easier Development and Maintenance** By separating the system into modules—such as the Discussion Module, Submission Module, Auth Module, and Contest Module—we can maintain clean boundaries within a single codebase. This structure enables faster development cycles and reduces merging conflicts.
- **Future Scalability** While CodeRank currently operates as a monolithic application, its modules are designed following **Domain-Driven Design (DDD)** principles. These boundaries can later be extracted into microservices if the system needs to scale. This ensures long-term flexibility without requiring microservices prematurely.
- **Technology Compatibility** Some components, such as the LLM-based Chatbot Module, rely on Python, whereas the main backend is developed in Go. To support cross-language integration without restructuring the entire system, we use gRPC communication and message queues, maintaining overall architectural simplicity.

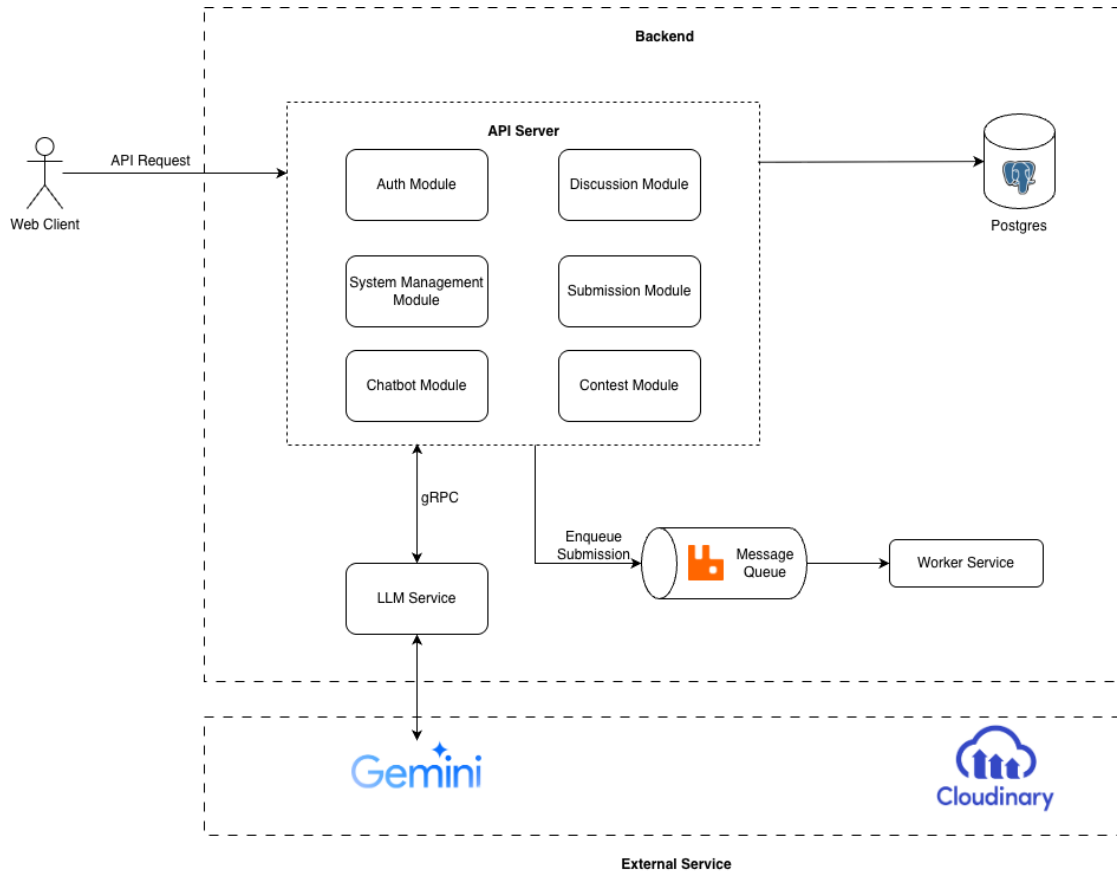


Figure 3.8: Architecture Diagram

3.3.3.2 System Components

The system architecture of CodeRank is organized into four primary layers, each responsible for a specific set of functions. This layered approach ensures clean separation of concerns, maintainability, and a clear mapping between business rules and system implementation.

1. Presentation Layer

The **Presentation Layer** acts as the entry point for all external interactions with the system. It exposes various controllers such as the *Problem Controller*, *Submission Controller*, *Discussion Controller*, and *Contest Controller*, which handle incoming HTTP requests from the web client. These controllers validate user input, map requests to the appropriate application use cases, and return responses in a structured format. This layer focuses purely on communication and does not contain business logic, ensuring the interface remains thin and easily adaptable.

2. Application Layer

The **Application Layer** contains the system's core orchestrators, known as Use Cases. Examples include the Problem Usecase, Discussion Usecase, Submission Usecase, and a dedicated Message Consumer for asynchronous tasks.

This layer coordinates operations between the Presentation Layer and the Domain Layer,

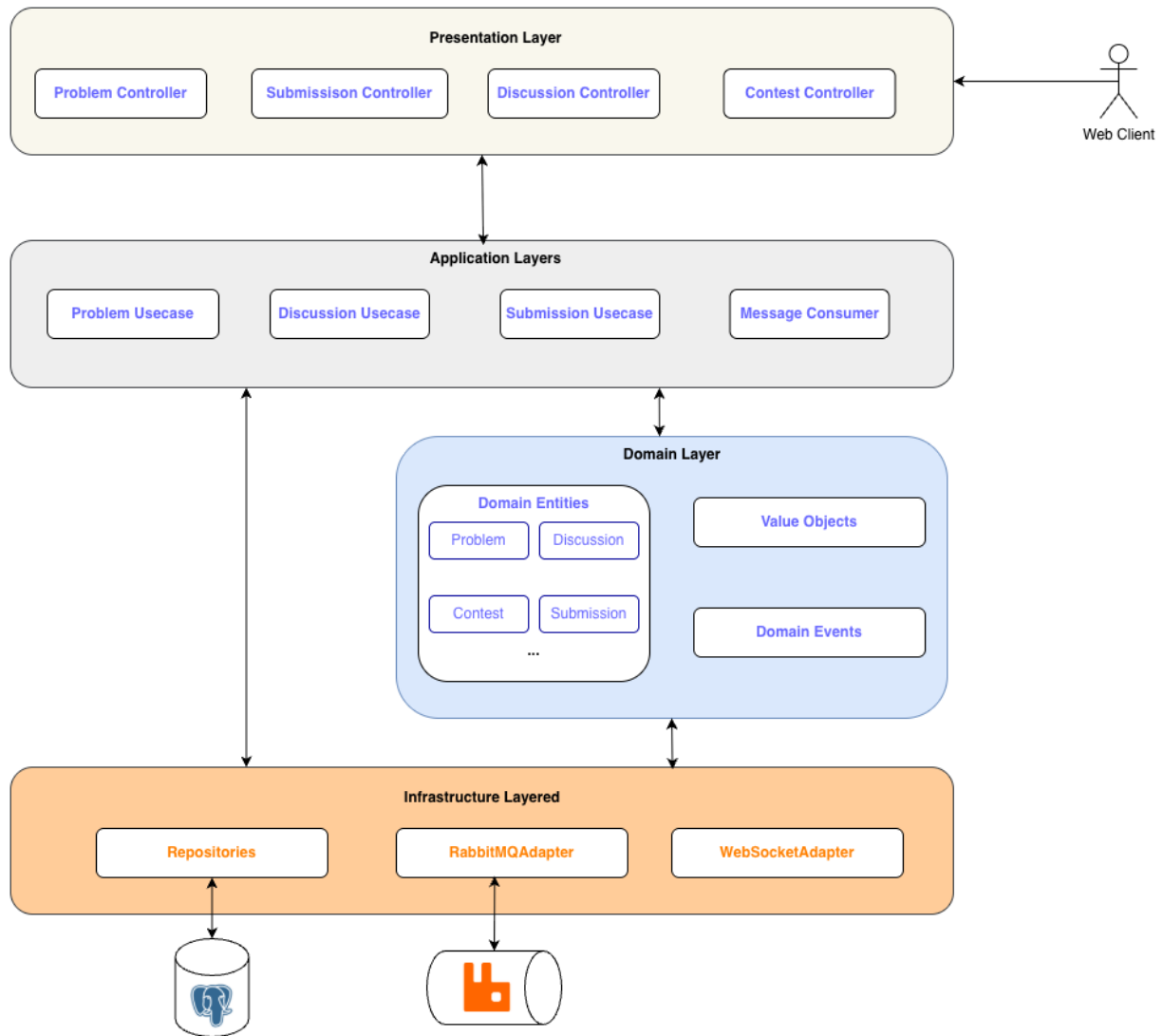


Figure 3.9: Layered Architecture

ensuring that business rules are executed in the correct sequence. It does not implement business rules itself; instead, it acts as a mediator, invoking domain logic and triggering events. This design improves code clarity and supports future expansion.

3. Domain Layer

The **Domain Layer** represents the heart of the application, where all business logic and system rules are defined. It contains:

- Domain Entities such as Problem, Discussion, Contest, and Submission.
- Value Objects that encapsulate immutable attributes or concepts. Domain Events used to capture and react to significant changes within the system.

- Domain Events used to capture and react to significant changes within the system.

4. Infrastructure Layer

The **Infrastructure Layer** provides the technical capabilities required to support the domain and application layers. It includes:

- **Repositories**, which manage communication with the PostgreSQL database.
- **RabbitMQ Adapters**, responsible for publishing and consuming messages for asynchronous processing. Domain Events used to capture and react to significant changes within the system.
- **WebSocket Adapters**, enabling real-time communication such as live updates for submissions or discussion activities.

This layer abstracts external systems and framework-specific operations, ensuring that the upper layers remain decoupled from technical implementation details.

3.4 Code Runner

3.4.1 Overview

Code Runner Component is a core component of Submission Worker Service, responsible for executing user-submitted programs against predefined test cases. It serves as a bridge between the user's solution and the problem's input–output data, ensuring fair and consistent evaluation. For each programming language supported by the platform (C++, Java, Python), a specific implementation of the **Code Runner** will be developed to handle language-specific compilation, execution, and output parsing. This ensures that user code is run correctly and consistently, regardless of the language chosen.

3.4.2 Class Diagram

- **ISerialization & Implementations**: ISerialization defines a common interface for converting data between raw test inputs/outputs and program variables. Its implementations — IntSerialization, FloatSerialization, StringSerialization, ListSerialization, and VoidSerialization — handle serialization for different data types, ensuring test cases are interpreted correctly regardless of format.
- **TestRunnerContext**: TestRunnerContext stores the configuration and metadata needed to execute a user's function, including parameter types, serializers, and the function reference itself. It prepares the environment for test execution and delegates the actual running to the Executor.
- **Executor**: Executor manages controlled execution of user-submitted functions. It enforces time limits, measures execution duration using Timer, and handles potential runtime issues like timeouts or errors during function calls.

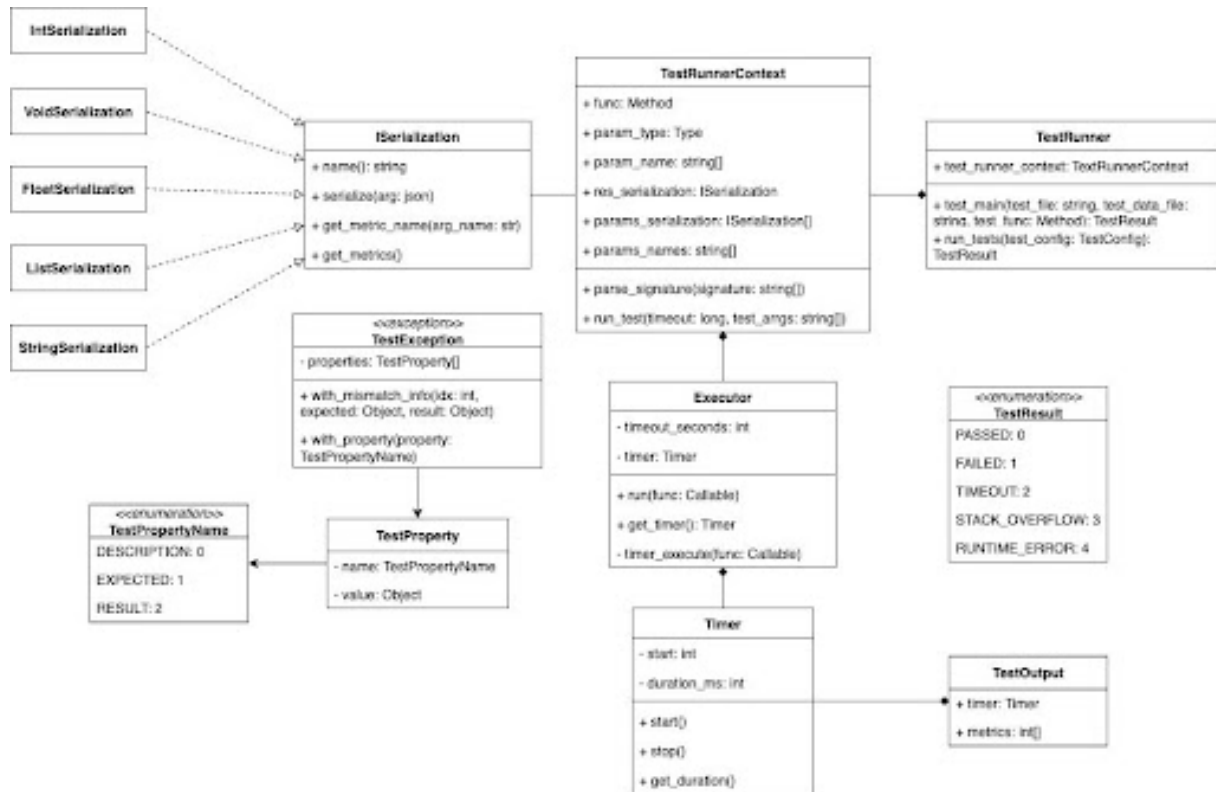


Figure 3.10: *Class Diagram for Code Runner*

- **Timer:** Timer measures how long each test case takes to execute. It provides simple start, stop, and duration tracking methods to record performance metrics for user solutions.
- **TestOutput:** TestOutput captures the results of a single test execution, storing both the runtime duration and any performance metrics. It is used to report how efficiently and accurately a user's code performed.
- **TestException:** TestException represents errors or mismatches that occur during test execution. It stores details such as expected versus actual results and additional context through TestProperty objects.
- **TestProperty & TestPropertyName:** TestProperty stores metadata about a test, such as a description or result comparison, identified by a TestPropertyName enum. These properties provide structured details for debugging failed test cases.
- **TestRunner:** TestRunner is the main controller responsible for running user code against predefined test cases. It coordinates between the TestRunnerContext, Executor, and ISerialization system to execute tests and produce final TestResult outcomes.
- **Solution:** Solution is the submission for the problem from the user.

3.4.3 Testcase Format

Each problem in the Online Judging System is accompanied by a test case file, named *problem_slug.csv*. This file defines a structured list of input–output test pairs used by the Test Runner of Worker Service to evaluate user submissions automatically. Moderators or superadmin upload

this file when creating or updating a problem. The judging system parses the CSV, runs user code against each test case, and compares the output with the expected result.

To ensure accurate and consistent evaluation of user submissions, each input and output value in the *problem_slug.csv* file is associated with a data type. The type system defines how each field should be parsed, validated, and compared during the judging process. This mechanism helps the Test Framework interpret user program outputs correctly, whether they are numbers, strings, booleans, or lists. The following table describes the type. Here is the content for the "Problem Storages" section, including the table about type format:

Type Token	Description
int	Integer numbers.
float	Floating-point numbers.
boolean	Boolean data.
string	Textual data.
void	Represents the absence of a value (e.g., for functions that return nothing).
list(type)	A collection of elements of a specified type (e.g., list(int)).

Each problem's test case file will contain both type definitions for input, expected output and test data. The first line of the file specifies the data types for all inputs and outputs, helping the Test Runner correctly parse and validate values before running tests.

After executing all test cases for a user's submission, the Test Runner generates a structured JSON result file summarizing the outcomes of each test. This file serves as the standardized output for the judging system and can be used by other services (such as the Result Service or API Gateway) to record, display, or analyze user performance. The JSON format ensures that results are machine-readable, language-independent, and easy to integrate into the overall online judging pipeline. The exported JSON file contains both metadata (e.g., problem name, language, execution status) and detailed per-test results (e.g., input, output, expected result, duration, and status).

Chapter 4

Future Plan and Work Evaluation

In Chapter 4, the authors will elucidate forthcoming plans and intentions for the next phase as well as evaluate the quality of the team's efforts.

Bibliography

- [1] AWS Firecracker Team. Firecracker: Lightweight virtualization for serverless computing. <https://firecracker-microvm.github.io/>, 2025. Accessed: 2025-12-02.
- [2] Proofpoint, Inc. What is a sandbox? <https://www.proofpoint.com/us/threat-reference/sandbox>, n.d. Accessed: 2025-12-02.